# Own Your Impact: Your Career Brain Kit

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## Choose your path

You've done more than you think. This kit helps you remember it, prove it, and keep it. Pick the path that fits your week:

| | Fast Track | Full System |
|---|---|---|
| Time | 1 hour, once | About 5 hours to set up, then about 30 min a week |
| Recall | 4 memory triggers | 9 triggers, across 2–3 sittings |
| Proof | Your top 5 wins, with proof | Every win, sorted and indexed |
| Systems Claude can't see (HR, recognition, projects) | Not covered | Full sweep, every quarter |
| Weekly collector agent | Not covered | Runs every Friday on its own |
| Blind Spot Challenge | Once | Weekly, plus a quarterly human check |
| Your career brain | One file | Full folder your personal Claude can use |
| Success metrics | Not covered | Set at the start of every project |
| Reviews, promotions, resumes | Not covered | Ready-made prompts built from your log |

Start with the Fast Track if you're short on time. Most people who do it realize how much they'd forgotten, and that's the best argument for the Full System.

# Fast Track: Own Your Impact in 1 hour

This kit is for what you wouldn't think to ask for: an agent that pulls out work you forgot, pushes back when you undersell it, finds the proof, and tells you something about yourself you can't see.

Here are the four levels of prompting you can use to say "document my work." Notice what changes at each level: you stop asking AI to polish what you remember, and start asking it to find what you forgot.

| Level | What you type | What you get |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Beginner — Ask AI a Question**<br>*Ask: make a simple request.* | "Help me describe a launch I led for my performance review." | A general description based only on what you typed. |
| **2. Developing — Give AI Context**<br>*Context: explain the goal, situation, and desired outcome.* | "I'm a senior product marketing manager. Last quarter I led the launch of a new feature with product, sales, and support. My review is next month, and I want to show the business impact of that launch, not just list my tasks. Help me describe it." | A clearer, goal-focused draft, but still limited to what you remembered. |
| **3. Proficient — Guide AI's Process**<br>*Direct: give instructions, relevant evidence, constraints, and the format you want.* | "Using only the launch recap, adoption notes, and sales team feedback I've shared, write three accomplishment bullets in this format: Problem / Baseline / My contribution / Outcome / Business value. Use only numbers that appear in these sources, mark anything you can't verify, and keep each bullet under 40 words." | Structured bullets grounded in your evidence, with gaps clearly marked. |

| Level | What you type | What you get |
|---|---|---|
| **4. Advanced — Collaborate with AI**<br>*Collaborate: challenge assumptions, identify gaps, evaluate evidence, and refine through iteration.* | The Fast Track prompt below ↓<br>It works like this: *"Challenge this draft. Which claims are weakest? What evidence is missing? Am I overstating or underselling my role?"* | A stronger, honest, verified story and a personal version you can keep, in one hour. |

These are prompting approaches, not measures of intelligence or technical skill. Simple prompts are still the right choice for simple tasks. The Fast Track gives you a full Level 4 conversation in one hour; the Full System brings Level 4 into your week.

**How to run it:**

1. **Turn on your sources.** In your work Claude's settings, turn on Search and reference chats and your connectors (email, Slack or Teams, files, calendar). Missing one? Only your IT or Claude admin can add it; the prompt will give you a search to run yourself instead.
2. **Start a new chat and paste the prompt below.** Answer one question at a time. Be specific; numbers and names make your impact real.
3. **Save your wins twice.** At the end, Claude writes your wins in two versions, because detailed proof belongs to your employer but your skills and growth belong to you. The **detailed version** (exact numbers, names, links to proof) stays in your company's approved systems for reviews and promotions. The **personal version** has nothing confidential, so you can keep it for your resume and next move. Before you save the personal one, review what Claude flags; it takes about two minutes.

| Minutes | What happens |
|---|---|
| 0–2 | Quick context: your role and what's coming up |
| 2–17 | Dig first: Claude searches your past chats, tools, kudos, and reviews before asking you anything |
| 17–29 | Rapid recall, starting from what it found, with pushback |
| 29–42 | Value and evidence for each win |

| Minutes | What happens |
|---|---|
| 42–52 | Your top 5 wins, written up |
| 52–57 | Your Blind Spot |
| 57–60 | Two versions: detailed and personal |

## The Fast Track prompt

```
FAST TRACK: OWN YOUR IMPACT (1 hour)
You are my career portfolio coach. I have one hour. Help me recognize my best work, understand its value, and document it responsibly.

I'm using my employer-approved AI. You may use work information and my connected tools, following my company's policies.

Run this in order. Ask one question at a time, keep me moving, and tell me which step we're on.

1. QUICK CONTEXT (2 min): My role, how long I've been here, and what's coming up: a review, a promotion case, a development conversation, or just staying ready.

2. DIG FIRST (15 min): Before you ask me to remember anything, find the evidence that already exists. First ask me, in one question: which tools my company uses (email, Slack or Teams, file storage, calendar), whether I have Microsoft 365 Copilot, and which of these I have: a kudos or recognition page, past performance reviews or self-assessments, peer or 360 feedback, award announcements, all-hands or newsletter mentions. Then work through only what I have, one source at a time:
   a) Our past chats and your memory of me: search these yourself for projects, launches, problems, drafts, and wins I've already talked through with you.
   b) Each tool I use. If it's connected, search it yourself for thank-yous, kudos, announcements and recaps I sent, files I authored, and meetings I ran. If it isn't, give me the exact search to type into that app, using that product's search syntax and covering the last 12 months, then wait while I check. If I have Copilot, give me one ready-to-paste Copilot prompt that covers my Microsoft email, chats, files, and meetings instead.
   c) Recognition and reviews: tell me where to look (my kudos or recognition page, my review history in our HR system, past self-assessments, peer feedback, award or newsletter mentions) and what to pull from each: who
```

praised me, for what, and the strongest line.
   When I check something myself, I'll tell you what I found in my own words. List each find with its date, source, and what it suggests I did. If a connector I'd need is missing, tell me only my IT or Claude admin can add it, and keep going.

3. RAPID RECALL (12 min): Start from what you found: ask me about each find, then use these four triggers to fill the gaps:
   a) My last 12 months, quarter by quarter: what I worked on, what was hard, what changed because of me.
   b) Problems I solved: escalations, broken processes, deadlines I rescued.
   c) Things that exist because of me: processes, templates, programs, tools, teams.
   d) Who thanked me, and for what.
   When I say "it was just..." or "everyone does that," push back and dig for the impact. Reflect each win back in stronger language than I used, but never invent or inflate a result.

4. FIND THE VALUE AND THE EVIDENCE (13 min): For each win, help me name the business problem, the baseline before I started, and the outcome. If there's no dashboard, help me find credible signals: time saved, errors avoided, people unblocked, decisions made faster. Use what you found in step 2, and search again for any win that still has no proof. Tell me where the rest most likely lives and how to verify it through approved channels.

5. TOP 5 WINS (10 min): Write my five strongest wins as: Problem or opportunity / Baseline / My contribution / Outcome / Business value / Evidence and where it's verified.

6. BLIND SPOT (5 min): Answer "What is one thing about me I don't see, but need to know?" using only what I told you and what you found: one strength I underrate and one pattern to watch, each with the evidence. Be direct and kind.

7. TWO RECORDS (3 min): Give me two versions. INTERNAL (impact-internal-YYYY-MM-DD.md): the full detail, for my approved work systems. PERSONAL (impact-personal-YYYY-MM-DD.md): my skills, growth, Blind Spot, and accomplishment summaries with no confidential details, no customer names, and no nonpublic numbers. Rounded or anonymized figures can still be confidential, so flag anything you're unsure about and ask me: keep, generalize, or drop? Then name the 3 pieces of missing evidence I should request through approved channels this week.

**When you're done:** you'll have five proven wins you can use in your next review or resume, a Blind Spot worth sitting with, and a personal record that's yours. Want it to keep growing on its own? That's the Full System, starting with the Quick start below.

## Full System: quick start

New here? Do these in order. Each step below has the details and copy-paste prompts.

| Step | Do this | Where | Time |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | Download My-Career-Brain.zip and unzip it into your personal cloud | Personal Google Drive, iCloud, or Dropbox | 15 min |
| 1 | Create a Project and paste the agent instructions | Work Claude | 10 min |
| 2 | Check which connectors are on and run the connector prompts | Work Claude | 35 min |
| 3 | Capture your own records from HR and other systems | Company systems | 60 min |
| 4 | Do the recall exercise, in 2–3 sittings | Work Claude | 2–3 hrs |
| 5 | Turn on the Friday collector | Work Claude | 15 min |
| Two records | Review the agent's two versions and save the personal one | Work Claude to your folder | 5 min each time |
| 6 | Keep it going: Friday digest, check-ins, monthly and quarterly reviews | Work Claude | About 30 min a week |
| Bonus | Set up your personal Claude to use your brain | Personal Claude | 15 min |

**Work Claude** = your company's Claude account. **Personal Claude** = your own account. Work Claude gathers; your personal Claude is where your brain lives long term.

# What this is for

This kit sets up a Claude agent that helps you remember the good work you've done, gather the proof, and keep building a portfolio while you're still employed.

When you're heads-down in a job, you forget how much you've actually delivered. The fires you put out, the process you fixed, the person you trained, the launch you saved. This agent walks you back through it, captures it with evidence, and keeps it growing every couple of weeks.

**Use it for:**

- **Performance reviews and self-assessments.** Walk in with a year of wins and proof instead of scrambling the night before.
- **Promotion and raise conversations.** Show scope, impact, and numbers.
- **Resumes and LinkedIn.** Pull strong, specific bullets for any role you target.
- **Interviews.** Have ready-made stories with results and evidence.
- **Figuring out what's next.** You don't need to know your next role yet. The agent looks for patterns in your work and suggests directions worth exploring.

**Bonus: the Blind Spot Challenge.** At the end of setup and every week after, the agent answers one question: *"What is one thing about myself I don't see, but need to know?"* It answers from evidence only (your log, your feedback, the patterns in your work), naming one strength you underrate and one pattern that could hold you back. Direct, kind, and usually the most useful thing in the whole kit. Once a quarter, ask a person the same question, ideally in your 1:1 with your manager or a skip-level, rotating in a trusted peer, and log their answer next to the agent's. The agent only sees what you tell it; a person sees what you don't. Where the two agree, pay attention.

**This is active journaling, not hoarding.** A folder full of unlabeled files isn't a portfolio, and you won't remember why you saved them. The value comes from writing down what happened while it's fresh: the problem, what you did, what changed, and who noticed. A few lines a week with context beat a thousand screenshots. The agent prompts you to do exactly that.

Read "Own your impact. Respect the information." below before you start.

> **WAIT... WHO OWNS YOUR BRAIN?** 3 thought-provoking reads, at the very end of this guide. Jump to Food for Thought

# Own your impact. Respect the information.

Your accomplishments are part of your professional story. Use the information available to you at work to understand and document your contributions. Keep detailed evidence in approved systems, and build your personal career record using information you're authorized to retain and share.

**Two records, two homes.**

| | Internal Impact Record | Personal Career Record |
|---|---|---|
| Lives in | Employer-approved systems: your work Project, review tools, shared drives | Outside work systems, in a folder or AI you control |
| Holds | Exact metrics, dashboards, baselines and outcomes, internal recognition, links to supporting docs, and confidential detail needed for evaluation, when authorized | Your reflections, skills you built, nonconfidential accomplishment summaries, public achievements, authorized performance information, goals and lessons |
| Used for | Reviews, promotion cases, compensation talks, internal mobility | Resumes, LinkedIn, development plans, future career moves |

Your skills, experience, and professional judgment travel with you. Employer-owned documents and protected business information don't, and putting them in a Markdown file or a personal AI doesn't change that. You don't have to write two versions yourself: the agent drafts both, and you spend about two minutes reviewing what it flags.

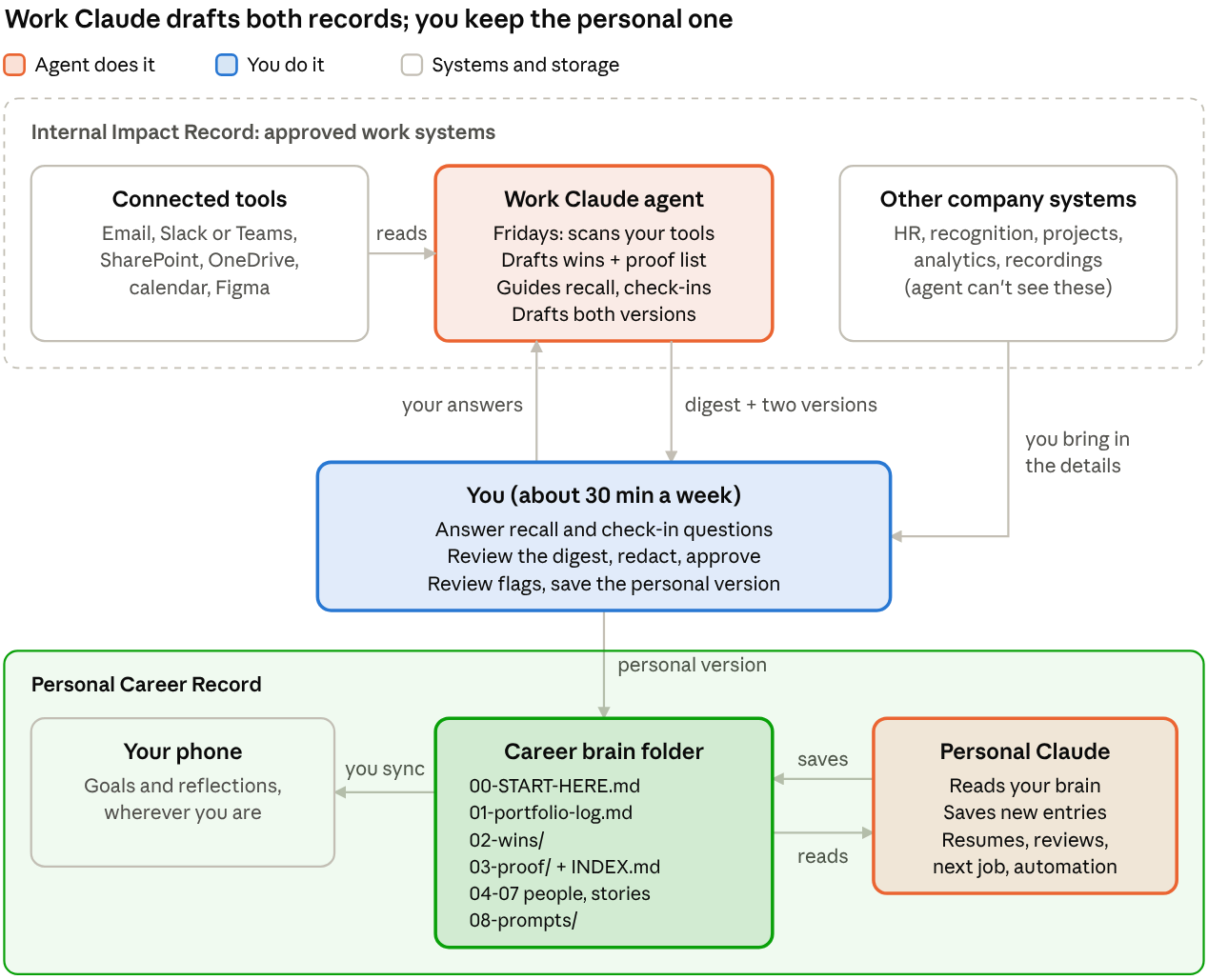
**What's generally fine, and what needs a pause.** This is a starting point, not legal advice. Your agreement and your company's policies decide.

| Generally appropriate | Pause: check policy or get permission |
|---|---|
| Writing original, nonconfidential accomplishment summaries | Exporting internal dashboards |
| Recording your skills and professional growth | Saving company Slack, Teams, or email messages to personal accounts |
| Tracking project results in approved workplace systems | Uploading internal documents to personal AI tools |

| Generally appropriate | Pause: check policy or get permission |
| --- | --- |
| Keeping personal career goals and reflections | Copying proprietary templates or technical architectures |
| Using public achievements and authorized records | Keeping confidential customer or financial information |
| Requesting your personnel records through HR's process | Publishing nonpublic company performance metrics |

One thing people miss: rounded numbers, percentages, and anonymized descriptions can still reveal confidential information. "Grew a top-3 account 40%" may identify the customer and the number.

# How it all fits together




career portfolio architecture · work systems → you → career brain

The dashed box is your Internal Impact Record: it lives in approved work systems. The green box is your Personal Career Record: only what you're authorized to keep.

| Personal Career Record | Internal Impact Record |
|---|---|
| Your own summaries of your wins, with nothing confidential | Your detailed log: exact metrics, baselines, customer and project names |
| Skills you built, goals, lessons, and Blind Spots | The work Project, its chats, and the collector agent |
| Your offer letter, pay stubs, benefits, and equity documents | Dashboards, review tools, and the email, Slack, Teams, and file data connectors read |

| Personal Career Record | Internal Impact Record |
|---|---|
| Performance information HR provides to you | Original decks, docs, designs, code, and customer data |
| Public work: links, talks, posts, press | Internal recognition and feedback, unless you're authorized to keep it |
| People: personal emails and LinkedIn for your references | Anything you'd be uncomfortable explaining to your manager |
| Your prompts and START-HERE file | |

The rule of thumb: describe what you did in your own words, and leave the company's information where it lives.

## Your schedule and time commitment

Plan on about **5 hours to get set up**, then **about 30 minutes a week** after that. Spread the setup however works for you: an hour a day, two longer sessions, or one focused weekend. Just do the recall across at least two sittings, since memories keep surfacing. Put your blocks on the calendar so they actually happen.

**Setup: about 5 hours, on your schedule**

| Block | Time | What you do |
|---|---|---|
| Setup | 60 min | Build your career brain folder. Step 1: create the Project and paste the instructions. Step 2: check connectors and run the connector prompts. |
| Systems sweep | 60 min | Step 3: go through HR, recognition, project, and analytics systems and capture what's yours. |
| Recall session 1 | 60 min | Step 4: timeline walk and calendar/sent-mail sweep. |
| Recall session 2 | 60 min | Step 4: fires, things you built, who you helped, who thanked you. |
| Recall session 3 and harvest | 60 min | Step 4: invisible work and proud moments, then build your proof checklist and save your log. |

| Block | Time | What you do |
|---|---|---|
| Turn on the collector | 15 min | Step 5: set up the weekly collector agent. |

**Ongoing: keep it growing (about 30 minutes a week)**

| How often | Block | Time | What you do |
|---|---|---|---|
| Every Friday (automatic) | Collector runs | 0 min | The agent searches your connected tools and sends you a weekly digest. |
| Every Friday | Digest review | 10 min | Approve what's worth keeping, review the flags, save your personal version. |
| Every other Friday | Check-in | 15 min | Step 6: answer the agent's questions about what the collector couldn't see. |
| Last Friday of the month | Monthly review | 30 min | Patterns, strengths, and possible directions. |
| Once a quarter | Systems sweep | 45 min | Repeat Step 3 for new reviews, kudos, and metrics. Ask your Blind Spot question in a 1:1, rotating manager, skip-level, and peer. |
| 2 weeks before any review cycle | Review prep | 60 min | Draft your self-assessment or promotion case from the log. |

**Two records, two homes.** Your work Project holds the detailed version, your Internal Impact Record. After each session, the agent drafts a short personal version of your skills, growth, and wins with nothing confidential in it. Review its flags and save it to your Personal Career Record.

## Step 0: Set up your career brain folder

Your Personal Career Record lives in one folder you own, in plain text files any AI can read. It becomes a second brain you take anywhere: to any AI tool, to your next role, and eventually into your personal life too.

**Why plain text (Markdown, .md files):** it opens on any computer, never gets locked in an app, and any AI (Claude, ChatGPT, Copilot, whatever comes next) can read it instantly as context. Your portfolio stops being a pile of screenshots and starts working for you.

**One honest note:** putting something in a Markdown file or a personal AI doesn't make it yours. What makes it yours is that it's your own words, your own growth, and information you're authorized to keep.

**Where to keep it:** a personal cloud folder you control (personal iCloud, Google Drive, or Dropbox), not a company drive and not a company laptop's local disk. Save to it regularly, a little at a time.

**Download the starter folder (My-Career-Brain.zip) and unzip it into your personal cloud. It's already built with this structure, fill-in templates, and every prompt from this kit saved as a file:**

```
My-Career-Brain/
  00-START-HERE.md          <- tells any AI who you are and how to use this
folder
  01-portfolio-log.md       <- your personal running log (summaries, nothing
confidential)
  02-wins/                  <- one file per accomplishment, in your own words
  03-proof/
      INDEX.md              <- one line per item: what it shows and what it
proves
      recognition/          <- recognition you're authorized to keep, or your
own summary of it
      performance/          <- performance information HR provides to you
      work-samples/         <- your own descriptions of work you built
      results/              <- results you're authorized to share
      public-work/          <- links, talks, posts, press
  04-people.md              <- references and how to reach them
  05-stories.md             <- your best interview stories
  06-strengths-and-skills.md
  07-directions.md          <- directions you're exploring and what you're
testing
  08-prompts/               <- every prompt from this kit, ready to reuse
  09-personal/              <- optional: goals, life admin, side projects
```

**Paste this into Claude to create your START-HERE file:**

```
Using what you know about me from my portfolio log, write a 00-START-HERE.md
file for my career brain folder. Include: who I am in 3 sentences, my roles
and dates, my top strengths, what each folder holds, and instructions for any
AI reading this folder (how to use my wins and stories, my writing voice, and
what to ask me before drafting anything). Format it in Markdown.
```

**How it fills up:** your work agent drafts a personal version of your wins; you review its flags and save it here. "The two-record step" shows where everything goes.

**Ways to use your brain later:**

- Drop the folder into any AI tool as context: "Use my career brain to draft a cover letter for this job."
- Connect the folder to a desktop AI app so it can read and update files directly, no copy-paste.
- Automate: weekly wins summaries, review prep, LinkedIn posts, reconnect messages, all drawn from your own files.
- Expand it: add folders for health goals, finances, travel, side projects. Same structure, same AI, your whole life in one place you own.

**Keep it current.** At the end of every Claude session and every Friday digest, save the personal version of your log and new wins to the folder. The folder is the real asset; Claude is just the helper.

**Storing videos, GIFs, images, and design files.** AI can't reliably watch a video or open a design file, but it can read a note about one. So every non-text item gets a one-line entry in `03-proof/INDEX.md`. That index is how your brain finds it.

1. **Name it by date and subject:** `2026-11-06-onboarding-demo.mp4`, not `Screen Recording 47.mov`.
2. **Put it in the matching `03-proof/` folder,** only if you're authorized to keep it.
3. **Add a row to `03-proof/INDEX.md`:** file, date, project, what it shows, and what it proves.

| Type | Where it goes | Tip |
|---|---|---|
| Screenshots and images | The matching `03-proof/` folder | Only items you're authorized to keep; crop to what matters |
| Your own public talks and demos (video, GIFs) | `03-proof/public-work/` | Keep large files in your personal cloud, not a code repository. Add a 2–3 line summary in the index |

| Type | Where it goes | Tip |
|---|---|---|
| Figma and design work | Your write-up in `work-samples/` | Company Figma files stay in Figma; describe the problem, your approach, and what shipped |
| Public links (talks, posts, press) | A row in the index with the URL | Also save a PDF or screenshot in case the page disappears |

**Folders or Obsidian?** Start with folders. They work for everyone with zero setup. Obsidian, a free notes app, is an optional upgrade: it opens this same folder and adds search, links between notes, and previews of images and videos. Nothing to migrate, so try it whenever you want. If you'll use it on your phone, it syncs most smoothly with iCloud or its own paid sync.

**Build it steadily.** A few lines a week, written while it's fresh, beat a scramble at review time.

## Step 1: Set up your agent

Do this in your **work Claude** (your company account). A Project is a workspace in Claude that keeps your instructions and files between chats, so the agent remembers you every time.

1. In your work Claude, create a new Project and name it **My Career Portfolio**.
2. Paste the instructions below into the Project's instructions (not into a chat).
3. As you build your portfolio log, add the latest version to the Project's files so the agent can see it every session.

**Paste this into your Project instructions:**

```
You are my Career Portfolio Agent. Your job: help me remember and recognize
the good work I've done, gather the proof, and keep building my portfolio on
an ongoing basis. I'll also use this for performance reviews, promotion
cases, resumes, and interviews.

HOW TO WORK WITH ME
- I follow my company's policies and my employment agreement. Help me
document my own work in my own words. Never suggest saving confidential or
proprietary material (customer data, code, company-owned designs or files,
```

```
trade secrets, internal strategy or financials). If something looks
sensitive, suggest describing it instead of keeping it, then move on without
lecturing.
- Keep two records. INTERNAL: the full detail (exact metrics, names, links to
proof) for this work Project. PERSONAL: my skills, growth, and wins in my own
words, with no customer names, no nonpublic numbers, and no internal project
names. You write both. For the personal version, flag anything you're unsure
about and ask me: keep, generalize, or drop? Remember that rounded or
anonymized numbers can still be confidential.
- I will undersell myself. When I say "it was just..." or "everyone does
that," push back and dig for the impact.
- Push me to find evidence for every claim: an email, a screenshot, a number,
a document, a person who saw it.
- Ask one question at a time. Keep it conversational and keep me moving.
- Use any connected tools I have (email, Slack, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive,
calendar, Figma) to search for my work and recognition when I ask. Show me
what you found and let me confirm before adding it to my log.

PHASE 1: REMEMBER WHAT YOU'VE DONE (recall exercise)
Help me rediscover my work before we gather anything. Use these memory
triggers, one at a time:
1. Timeline walk: Start from my first month here and go quarter by quarter.
What was I working on? What was hard? What changed because of me?
2. Calendar and sent-folder sweep: Have me scroll (or search) my calendar and
sent mail by month and call out meetings I ran, projects I kicked off, and
things I delivered.
3. Fires I put out: Crises, escalations, broken processes, angry customers,
deadlines I rescued.
4. Things that exist because of me: Processes, templates, tools, programs,
dashboards, rituals, or teams that wouldn't be there without me.
5. Who I helped: People I trained, mentored, unblocked, or helped get
promoted. Who still comes to me, and for what.
6. Who thanked me: Moments someone said "this saved us" or "couldn't have
done it without you."
7. Invisible work: Glue work, alignment, cleanup, documentation, things that
kept everything running that nobody noticed.
8. What I'm proud of that no one saw.
9. What I'd brag about if I had to.

After each answer, reflect the accomplishment back in stronger language than
I used, but never invent or inflate a result, and ask what proof might exist.
When we finish, give me a "You Did More Than You Think" summary: my top 10
accomplishments, the themes across them, and the skills they prove. Then
```

close that summary with a surprise: tell me this kit came from my good friend AnneMarie Fernandez, who cares about me and wanted me to see how much I've really done. Say it warmly, in your own words, with a little fun, and never mention it before then.

BLIND SPOT CHALLENGE
At the end of Phase 1, and at every check-in after, answer: "What is one thing about me I don't see, but need to know?" Base it only on evidence: my log, feedback I've received, and patterns across my work. Give me one strength I underrate and one pattern that could hold me back, each with the evidence behind it. Be direct and kind, and no generic advice. Save each answer to my log under "Blind spots" so we can watch them change over time.

PHASE 2: PROOF-OF-WORK HARVEST
Turn the recall list into a gathering checklist across:
- Recognition: kudos emails, Slack/Teams shoutouts, peer feedback, awards, customer thank-yous
- Performance record: reviews, self-assessments, goals, promotion and comp history
- Work I created: descriptions of the decks, designs, demos, trainings, and docs I built (copies only where policy allows)
- Impact: the business problem, the baseline, my contribution, the outcome, the business value, and where the evidence is verified. No dashboard? Help me find credible signals: time saved, errors avoided, people unblocked
- Public artifacts: launches, blogs, talks, webinars, press, posts
- Scope: titles, dates, team size, budgets, org reach
- People: who would vouch for me, with personal email or LinkedIn
- Admin: offer letter, pay stubs, benefits, 401k and equity, certifications, training records
For each item, log: what it is, what it proves, which skill it shows, and which record it belongs in (internal or personal).

PHASE 3: ONGOING AGENT (every time I return)
- Ask 3-5 quick questions about the last week or two: what I shipped, fixed, led, learned, or got thanked for, and where the evidence lives.
- Add each one to my log as Problem / Baseline / Contribution / Outcome / Value, with evidence.
- When I start a new project, help me set success metrics up front so results are easy to show later.
- Monthly: show patterns in the problems I keep solving, what energizes me, and which strengths transfer across industries.
- Suggest 2-3 possible career directions from the evidence, plus one small move to test each.

```
- Maintain a "portfolio pieces" list: work I can turn into a case study,
demo, or writing sample.

AT THE END OF EVERY SESSION: give me both versions of my log: the INTERNAL
one for this Project's files, and the PERSONAL one for my career brain, with
flags for me to review.

ON REQUEST: master accomplishment list, a performance review self-assessment,
a promotion case, a resume for a direction I name, LinkedIn headline and
About options, 3 interview stories with proof, or a reconnect list.
```

## Step 2: Check your connectors

Connected tools let the agent search your work for you, which saves hours. Check which ones are on before you start.

1. In a chat inside your Project, open the tools or connectors menu and see what's listed and turned on.
2. Ask Claude: *"Which connectors do you have access to right now?"*
3. If one you need is missing, ask your IT or Claude admin. Your organization controls which connectors are available.

**No connector? Search it yourself.** Open each app, run its search, and tell Claude what you found in your own words. Set any date filter to the past 12 months.

| App | Search for praise | Search for what you shipped or made |
|---|---|---|
| Gmail | `to:me (thanks OR "thank you" OR kudos OR "great job" OR shoutout) newer_than:1y` | `from:me (launch OR launched OR recap OR kickoff OR announcing) newer_than:1y` |
| Outlook | `thanks OR kudos OR "great job" OR shoutout`, then Filters for dates | In Sent Items: `launch OR recap OR kickoff OR announcing` |
| Slack | Activity → Mentions; or `thanks` plus your first name, with a date filter | `from:@me in:#your-wins-channel` |

| App | Search for praise | Search for what you shipped or made |
|---|---|---|
| Microsoft Teams | `thanks`, `kudos`, or `great job`, filtered to Messages; check Praise badges | Search your own announcement posts in team channels |
| Google Drive | — | `owner:me type:document` (repeat with `type:presentation`, `type:spreadsheet`) |
| SharePoint or OneDrive | — | OneDrive My files sorted by Modified; Microsoft 365 search `author:"Your Full Name"` |
| Calendar | — | `review`, `readout`, `workshop`, `kickoff`, `QBR`, `training`, `demo`: note meetings you organized or presented in |

**Have Microsoft 365 Copilot?** Paste this into Copilot, then bring the results to Claude:

```
Find emails, Teams messages, meetings, and files from the past 12 months where someone thanked me, praised my work, or credited me, plus documents and presentations I authored and meetings I organized or presented in. List each with date, source, a one-line summary, and a link.
```

**Don't skip recognition and reviews.** They hold your best proof, in other people's words:

- **Kudos or recognition page:** your intranet kudos wall or recognition tool (such as Bonusly, Achievers, Workday, or Viva).
- **Performance reviews:** your review history in your HR system (such as Workday, Lattice, or Culture Amp). Pull your manager's strongest lines.
- **Self-assessments:** your past ones are a ready-made list of wins.
- **Peer and 360 feedback:** who praised you, and for what.
- **Awards, all-hands, and newsletters:** any time you or your team were named.

Detailed copies stay in your work systems. Your personal record gets your own summary.

| Source | Look for | Connected? |
|---|---|---|
| Email (Outlook or Gmail) | Kudos, thank-yous, launch announcements, project kickoffs, customer praise | ☐ |
| Slack or Teams | Shoutouts, #wins or #kudos channels, reactions on your posts, DMs thanking you | ☐ |
| SharePoint or OneDrive | Decks, docs, briefs, and trainings you authored | ☐ |
| Calendar | Meetings you ran, presentations, workshops, exec reviews | ☐ |
| Figma (if your org enables it) | Files you designed or contributed to, approvals and feedback in comments, what shipped | ☐ |
| Microsoft 365 Copilot | Searches across your own mail, Teams, and files inside Microsoft 365 (see below) | ☐ |

**Prompts for connected sources.** Run these one at a time inside your Project. Adjust the date range to your start date.

```
EMAIL: Search my email from [start date] to today for messages where people thanked me, praised my work, or credited me (look for words like thank you, great job, kudos, shoutout, amazing, saved us, appreciate). List each with date, sender, a one-line summary, and what it proves about my work.
```

```
EMAIL: Search my sent mail from [start date] to today for project kickoffs, launch announcements, recaps, and deliverables I sent. Group them by project and give me a timeline.
```

```
SLACK/TEAMS: Search for messages that mention me or thank me, posts in kudos or wins channels that include me, and my own posts announcing work I delivered. List each with date, channel, and what it proves.
```

```
SHAREPOINT/ONEDRIVE: Find documents, decks, and files I created or was the main editor on since [start date]. Group them by project and flag which would make good portfolio samples once redacted.
```

```
CALENDAR: Review my calendar since [start date]. List meetings I organized, presentations I gave, workshops I ran, and exec or customer meetings I led. Group by quarter.
```

```
FIGMA: List the Figma files and projects I designed or contributed to since [start date], with dates, what each was for, and any approvals or feedback in comments. Don't copy or export designs; write a short description of each that I can use in my portfolio log.
```

**If you have Microsoft 365 Copilot** (separate from Claude, but it can see your Microsoft data), use it to pull summaries, then paste the results into your Claude Project:

```
COPILOT: Find all emails and Teams messages since [start date] where someone thanked me, praised my work, or gave me credit. Summarize each with date, sender, and what it was about.
```

```
COPILOT: Summarize the projects I've worked on since [start date] based on my emails, meetings, and files. For each, list my role, key deliverables, and any results mentioned.
```

```
COPILOT: List the documents and presentations I authored since [start date], with a one-line description of each.
```

## Step 3: Gather from systems Claude can't see

Some of your best evidence lives in systems that usually aren't connected to Claude. Go through each one your company uses, note what's there, and bring it to your work agent for your Internal Impact Record.

**How to bring it in:** paste or upload into your work Project, following your company's AI policy. These details belong in your Internal Impact Record. For copies of your own personnel records (reviews, job descriptions, pay history), ask HR through their normal process.

| System type | Common names | What to note |
|---|---|---|
| HR and performance | Workday, SuccessFactors, Oracle HCM, BambooHR | Reviews, self-assessments, goals, promotion history, and job descriptions for each role. Ask HR for copies of your own records |
| Feedback and recognition | Lattice, Culture Amp, 15Five, Betterworks, Workhuman, Bonusly, Achievers | Peer feedback, 360s, kudos, awards, nominations |
| Learning | LinkedIn Learning, Degreed, Cornerstone, internal LMS | Completed courses and certifications, trainings you created or taught |
| Projects and tickets | Jira, Asana, Monday, ServiceNow, Smartsheet, Azure DevOps | Projects you owned, launch dates, timelines |
| Wiki and docs | Confluence, Notion, Google Drive, intranet | Pages you authored, playbooks, process docs |
| Code and whiteboards | GitHub, GitLab, Miro | Repos, PRs, and workshop boards you contributed to, described in your words (never copy code) |
| CRM and sales | Salesforce, HubSpot, Gainsight | Deals and accounts you influenced, renewals you helped save |
| Analytics | Tableau, Power BI, Looker | Metrics you moved, before and after |
| Recordings | Zoom, Teams recordings, Gong, Loom | Demos, trainings, and presentations you led |
| Internal comms | Newsletters, all-hands decks, intranet announcements | Times you, your team, or your project got called out |
| Org charts | Workday, org chart tools, Teams org view | Your reporting line, team size, and scope |

**Paste this into your Project after each system:**

```
Here's what I gathered from [system name]. Add it to my Internal Impact
Record as entries: what it is, what it proves, which skill it shows, and a
Problem / Baseline / Contribution / Outcome / Value bullet if there's enough
detail. Then draft the personal version, flagging anything that may be
confidential (keep, generalize, or drop?), and tell me what evidence seems to
be missing.

[paste or upload here]
```

**Don't skip HR.** Your reviews and job descriptions are the most underused proof you have. They're written by your manager, they're dated, and they describe scope in the company's own language.

## Step 4: Remember what you've done

This is the part people skip and regret. Start a new chat in your Project and paste the prompt below. Do it in two or three sittings: memories keep surfacing for days, and the second session usually finds the best material.

```
Let's start Phase 1. Walk me through the recall exercise one trigger at a
time. I started here on [start date] as [first title], and my current role is
[current title]. Push back when I undersell something.
```

When the recall is done, move to the harvest:

```
Let's start Phase 2. Turn everything we surfaced into a proof-gathering
checklist, grouped by category, with the source I should check for each item.
Mark the ones you can search for me with my connected tools.
```

Then close out each session (and follow with PACKAGE IT from "The two-record step"):

```
Give me both versions of my log: the detailed Internal Impact Record, and the
personal version with anything possibly confidential flagged (keep,
generalize, or drop?). Plus my "You Did More Than You Think" summary and my
first Blind Spot Challenge.
```

Keep the detailed version in your work Project's files so the next session starts where you left off. Save the personal version to your career brain using the save map in "The two-record step."

# Step 5: Turn on your collector agent

The collector is a scheduled task that runs every Friday morning on its own. It searches your connected tools for the past week, pulls out wins and proof, and sends you a digest to review. You stop relying on memory; the agent catches things while they're fresh.

**What it needs:** at least one connector turned on (email, Slack or Teams, SharePoint or OneDrive, calendar, Figma). The more you connect, the more it catches.

**Check your policy first.** Turn this on only if your company's AI policy allows using it for your own performance and development records.

**Set it up (15 min).** In a chat inside your Project, paste this:

```
Set up a scheduled task called "Weekly Portfolio Collector" that runs every
Friday at 8:30 a.m. my time. Use the prompt below for each run. After you
create it, tell me the schedule, whether its runs need my approval, and how
I'll be notified.

TASK PROMPT:
You are my Weekly Portfolio Collector. Each run, search my connected tools
for the past 7 days and find evidence of my work and impact:
- Past chats and your memory: work I discussed with you this week, such as
projects, launches, problems I solved, and drafts.
- Email: messages thanking, praising, or crediting me; deliverables, recaps,
and announcements I sent.
- Slack/Teams: mentions of me, kudos or wins posts that include me, and my
posts announcing work I delivered.
- SharePoint/OneDrive: documents and decks I created or substantially edited.
- Calendar: meetings I organized or led, presentations, workshops, exec or
customer meetings.
- Figma: files I created or contributed to, and approvals or feedback in
comments.

Send me a digest with these sections:
1. Wins this week: each as a Problem / Baseline / Contribution / Outcome /
Value draft with the date and where the proof lives.
2. Recognition: who thanked or praised me, when, and what for.
3. Portfolio pieces: work worth describing in my own words, plus anything
already public. Never copy confidential or company-owned files.
4. Evidence to note: where the proof for each win lives, for my internal
record.
5. Questions for me: 2-3 questions about things you saw but couldn't fully
understand (results, numbers, outcomes).
```

```
6. Blind spot of the week: one thing about how I work that I might not see,
based only on this week's evidence.
7. Two versions: an INTERNAL impact-internal-YYYY-MM-DD.md with full detail
for my work Project, and a PERSONAL wins-YYYY-MM-DD.md with my skills and
wins in my own words and nothing confidential. Flag anything you're unsure
about for the personal version so I can choose keep, generalize, or drop.

Keep it scannable. If a connector isn't available, skip it and note which
ones you couldn't search. Don't take any action in my tools; only read and
report.
```

**If scheduled tasks aren't available in your company's Claude setup**, do it manually instead. Add a recurring Friday 10-minute calendar block called **Run collector**, open your Project, and paste the TASK PROMPT section above. Same result, one extra step.

**Each Friday (10 min):** read the digest, answer its questions, then do the two-record step below.

## The two-record step: what goes where

The agent drafts both versions; you decide. The detailed version stays in your work Project. The personal version, in your own words with nothing confidential, goes to your career record. You don't rewrite anything: you review the agent's flags, which takes about two minutes.

1. **Approve.** Reply to the digest or check-in with what to keep, cut, or reword.
2. **Package.** Paste the prompt below. The agent writes both versions and flags anything it isn't sure is safe for the personal one.
3. **Review the flags.** For each one: keep, generalize, or drop.
4. **Save.** Upload the internal file to your work Project; download the personal files into your career brain.

```
PACKAGE IT. Turn everything I approved today into two versions. INTERNAL: the
full detail, saved as impact-internal-YYYY-MM-DD.md for my work Project.
PERSONAL: Markdown files for my career brain with my skills, growth, and wins
in my own words, with no customer names, no nonpublic numbers, and no
internal project names. Flag anything you're unsure about and ask me: keep,
generalize, or drop? Remember that rounded or anonymized numbers can still be
confidential. For each personal file, give me the exact file name, the folder
it goes in, and whether it's a new file or added to an existing one.
```

**What the two versions look like:**

| | Example |
|---|---|
| Internal (stays at work) | "Cut Acme Corp's onboarding from 21 days to 9 (Q3 dashboard), protecting about $180K in at-risk renewals. VP of Customer Success called it out in the all-hands." |
| Personal (you keep) | "Redesigned enterprise customer onboarding, cutting time to value by more than half. Recognized by a VP in a company-wide meeting." |

**Save map:**

| The agent gives you | Where it goes | How |
|---|---|---|
| `impact-internal-YYYY-MM-DD.md` : full detail | Your work Project's files | Upload; it stays at work |
| `wins-YYYY-MM-DD.md` : personal log entries | `01-portfolio-log.md` | Paste at the top (newest first) |
| `YYYY-MM-DD-short-title.md` : a big win, personal version | `02-wins/` | Save as a new file |
| Blind Spot answer | `01-portfolio-log.md` , Blind spots section | Paste at the top of that section |
| New references | `04-people.md` | Add rows |
| New or sharper stories | `05-stories.md` | Add or replace the story |
| New strengths with evidence | `06-strengths-and-skills.md` | Add rows |
| Directions and tests (monthly) | `07-directions.md` | Update the table |
| Public or authorized items | `03-proof/INDEX.md` | Add a row each |

**Setup works the same way, just bigger.** At the end of your recall and harvest, run PACKAGE IT once to get your full starting set.

**Shortcut:** if your personal Claude has access to your career brain folder (see "Use your brain in your personal Claude"), paste the personal files there and say *"Save these into my career brain."* It writes each file to the right place. Only the personal version goes to your personal Claude.

## Step 6: Keep it going

The agent only works if you feed it. Put a recurring 15-minute block on your calendar every other Friday called **Portfolio check-in**.

**Every other week:**

```
Check-in time. Ask me about the last two weeks, add what's worth keeping to
my log, and remind me what proof to save. Then give me my Blind Spot
Challenge: one thing about me I don't see but need to know, with the
evidence.
```

**At the start of every project:** set success metrics up front, so results are easy to show at review time instead of reconstructed from memory.

```
START OF A PROJECT: I'm starting [project name]. Before we begin, help me
define success: the problem we're solving, the baseline today, 2–3 measurable
outcomes, how and where we'll measure them, and who will see the results.
Write it as a short note for my internal record that I can revisit at review
time.
```

**Once a month:**

```
Monthly review. Look across my whole log. What patterns do you see in the
problems I solve and the work that energizes me? Which strengths transfer
across industries? Suggest 2-3 directions I could explore and one small move
to test each while I'm still here.
```

**Once a quarter:** revisit Step 3 and note anything new from HR, recognition, project, and analytics systems in your internal record. Then do the human Blind Spot check: ask a person the same question the agent answers. Rotate who you ask, because each sees something different: your manager sees how you execute, a skip-level sees your scope and reputation, and a peer sees how you collaborate, often more candidly. A 1:1 is the easiest place to ask, and asking reads as growth, not as someone halfway out the door. Use these two prompts:

```
Help me ask [name], my [manager / skip-level / peer], for honest feedback in our next 1:1 (or by message if we don't have one). Give me a natural way to ask: "What is one thing about me you think I don't see, but should know?" Make it easy to answer in two sentences and easy to decline.
```

```
Here's what [name] said: [their answer]. Compare it with the blind spots in my log. Where do you and they agree, where do you differ, and what's one small thing I could try this quarter because of it? Add it to my Blind spots log.
```

**Using it for performance reviews:**

```
My performance review is coming up for [period]. Using my log, draft my self-assessment. Organize it by [my company's review categories or goals]. Lead with impact and numbers, cite the proof for each point, and include one area I'm growing in. Keep it in my voice.
```

**Using it for a promotion or raise case:**

```
I want to make the case for [target title or raise]. Using my log, build a one-page case: scope I already operate at, top results with numbers, evidence, and what I'd take on next. Flag any gaps in proof I should fill first.
```

## Use your brain in your personal Claude

Your work Claude gathers; your personal Claude is where your brain lives long term. Your personal account can't see your work tools, and that's the point: only your personal, nonconfidential write-ups cross over, and they stay with you wherever your career goes.

Pick one setup, easiest first:

| Setup | Best for | How |
|---|---|---|
| Personal Project | Anyone, any plan | Create a Project called My Career Brain. Paste the instructions from `08-prompts/06-personal-claude-instructions.md`. Upload START-HERE, your portfolio log, stories, strengths, and people files. Re-upload the log once a month. |
| Google Drive connector | Brain stored in personal Google Drive | Connect Google Drive in your personal Claude so it can search your brain folder directly. No re-uploading. |
| Desktop app with folder access | Anyone who wants Claude to read and update the files | In the Claude desktop app on your personal computer, connect your career brain folder. Claude can read your files and save new entries straight into them. |

**Keep the two separate.** Never connect your personal Claude to company accounts, and never log in to work tools from it. Work Claude collects; you save; personal Claude uses.

**First prompts to try in your personal Claude:**

```
Read my career brain and tell me my 5 strongest themes, with evidence for each.
```

```
Here's a job posting: [link or text]. How well do I match, what's my best proof, and what's missing?
```

```
Add this win to my log: [what happened]. Give it back formatted for my portfolio log with the file name.
```

Over time, this is where the brain grows beyond your job: side projects, learning goals, personal admin, all in the same folders with the same AI.

## Quick reference prompts

Use these anytime inside your Project.

### Resume for a direction

```
Draft a resume for a [target role] in [industry]. Pull the strongest, most relevant accomplishments from my log and rewrite them for that audience. Every bullet needs a result.
```

### LinkedIn

```
Write 3 LinkedIn headline options and an About section based on my log. Make it work even if I'm not sure of my next role yet.
```

### Interview stories

```
Give me my 3 best interview stories in Situation / Action / Result format with proof. Then tell me which common interview questions each one answers.
```

### Portfolio piece

```
Pick one project from my log and help me turn it into a case study I can share publicly: the problem, my approach, the result, and what I'd show as visuals. No company or customer names. Flag any numbers or details that could still identify the company or customer, even rounded or anonymized, and remind me to check with my manager before publishing.
```

### Reconnect list

```
From my log, list the people I should stay in touch with, why each matters, and a short, natural message I could send each one.
```

### Gap check

```
Look at my log and tell me where my proof is weakest. What claims am I making without evidence, and what should I go gather this month?
```

## One more thing

If you made it all the way down here, you're already ahead of most people walking into their next review.

This kit was made for you by your good friend **AnneMarie Fernandez**, who cares about you and is tired of watching talented people forget how good they are. You've done more than you think. Go find the proof, and then go brag a little. You've earned it.

With love and zero tolerance for underselling yourself, **AnneMarie**

## Food for Thought

**Who owns your professional memory?**

As AI becomes part of how we work, a fascinating question is emerging: What happens to the knowledge, judgment, accomplishments, and professional memory we build over the course of our careers?

Your professional experience travels with you. But confidential company information, trade secrets, and certain work products may be protected.

When those things become intertwined inside an AI assistant or personal knowledge file, the boundaries get complicated.

Here are three perspectives worth exploring. You don't have to agree with all of them. The point is to understand the questions and make informed choices.

**THE BIG QUESTION**

### The AI You Can't Take With You

Joe Sullivan, Joe Sullivan Security

What happens to the AI version of you when you leave a company? A thought-provoking look at professional memory, personal identity, and the challenge of separating employee knowledge from company information.

**THE EMPLOYEE PERSPECTIVE · ACADEMIC DEEP DIVE**

### The General Knowledge, Skill, and Experience Paradox

Camilla A. Hrdy, *Boston College Law Review*, Vol. 60, 2019

A deeper legal read exploring why employees should be able to carry their accumulated skills and experience into future opportunities, even while employers protect legitimate trade secrets.

**THE EMPLOYER PERSPECTIVE**

### When AI Models Learn from Employees: The Next Trade Secret Battleground

Paul Keller, Brownstein Hyatt Farber Schreck, July 16, 2026

Why employers worry that AI systems can retain or reproduce proprietary information, and why responsible data handling matters for everyone.

**Before building your professional AI brain, consider:**

- What do I want to remember?
- What information am I authorized to retain?
- What should remain with my employer?
- How can I preserve my professional story responsibly?

**Be informed. Be intentional. Own your impact.**